WEEK 2 · LECTURE L3 · UNIT II

The Job Demands Resources Model

The dual process model of engagement and burnout, its propositions, and the critique that challenge and hindrance demands differ.

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AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Explain the two processes of the Job Demands Resources model.
- State the main propositions of Job Demands Resources theory.
- Distinguish challenge demands from hindrance demands, with evidence.
- Compare Job Demands Resources, Kahn and self determination readings of the same data.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 2 (apply validated engagement models) and CLO 4 (interpret engagement data).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

A team reports high demands and low resources. Should HR cut demands or add resources?

Choose one and give one sentence of reasoning.

THE DUAL PROCESS MODEL

Two processes, not one scale

Process	Chain	Outcome
Health impairment	High demands lead to exhaustion	Health problems and burnout
Motivational	Job resources lead to engagement	Performance and commitment

EXAM LENS

Burnout and engagement are not opposite ends of one line. Different drivers move each.

Demerouti et al. (2001); Schaufeli and Bakker (2004)

PROPOSITIONS · BAKKER AND DEMEROUTI (2017)

What the theory predicts

BUFFERING

Job resources weaken the effect of demands on strain.

COPING

Resources matter most for motivation when demands are high.

PERSONAL RESOURCES

Optimism and self efficacy work like job resources.

SPIRALS

Engaged people craft more resources; exhausted people create more demands.

MEASURING THE STATE · SCHAUFELI ET AL. (2002)

The Utrecht Work Engagement Scale

VIGOR

High energy and mental resilience while working.

DEDICATION

Significance, enthusiasm, pride and challenge.

ABSORPTION

Full concentration; time passes quickly.

KEY POINT

The UWES measures engagement as a positive state, separately from burnout, so the two can be studied side by side.

THEORY IN DEPTH · BAKKER AND DEMEROUTI (2017)

Job Demands Resources theory

THE CORE IDEA

Every job has demands that cost energy and resources that help achieve goals and grow.

HOW IT WORKS

Demands drive strain through exhaustion; resources drive engagement; resources buffer demands; spirals build over time.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

So broad that almost any job feature fits; it predicts direction better than which resource matters most.

IN PRACTICE

A hospital ward adds nurse coaching (a resource) during peak season; strain falls less than engagement rises.

EXAM LENS

The default diagnostic model in exams. Strengthen it by naming specific demands and resources, not generic ones.

THEORY IN DEPTH · CRAWFORD, LEPINE AND RICH (2010)

Not all demands are alike

THE CORE IDEA

Demands split into challenge demands, which can engage, and hindrance demands, which do not.

HOW IT WORKS

Workload, time pressure and responsibility related positively to engagement; red tape, role conflict and hassles negatively.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Whether a demand is a challenge or a hindrance can depend on the person and the context.

IN PRACTICE

A sales team keeps its targets but loses its paperwork: the challenge stays, the hindrance goes.

EXAM LENS

Use it to refine any Job Demands Resources answer: ask which demands to cut, not how many.

COMPARE AND EVALUATE

Same data, three diagnoses

Lens	Reads high demands and low resources as	First action
Job Demands Resources	A resource deficit against demands	Inject resources where demand is highest
Kahn	A sign of low availability	Ask what depletes energy and safety
Self determination	Needs thwarted by control	Audit support for autonomy and competence

EXAM LENS

A strong answer uses one model to diagnose and another to test the diagnosis.

APPLY IT · ILLUSTRATIVE CASES

Demands and resources in Indian workplaces

A CALL CENTER

High hindrance demands: scripted calls, strict monitoring. Resource: peer support and schedule control.

A FIELD SALES TEAM

High challenge demands: targets and travel. Resource: coaching and fair territory design.

A HOSPITAL WARD

High emotional demands. Resource: staffing ratios and recovery time between shifts.

EXAM TIP

Illustrations for analysis, not real firms. Classify each demand as challenge or hindrance before prescribing.

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

"Reducing job demands is the best way to raise engagement." Critically evaluate using Job Demands Resources theory. **20 marks**

A strong answer: explains both processes; uses Crawford et al. on challenge and hindrance demands; discusses buffering; reaches a nuanced position.

Compare Job Demands Resources theory with Kahn's three conditions as diagnostic frameworks. **20 marks**

A strong answer: contrasts mechanisms, level and measurement; shows where they agree; applies both to one case.

What does the UWES measure? **10 marks**

A strong answer: names vigor, dedication and absorption; explains engagement as a state distinct from burnout.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. Burnout and engagement run on two different processes
2. Resources buffer demands and matter most when demands are high
3. Cut hindrance demands; keep challenge demands, with resources to match

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Kahn, W. A. (1990). Psychological conditions of personal engagement and disengagement at work. *Academy of Management Journal, 33*(4), 692–724. (Lesson Plan: Sections I to III.)

Bhatnagar, J. (2007). Talent management strategy of employee engagement in Indian ITES employees: Key to retention. *Employee Relations, 29*(6), 640–663.

Bakker, A. B., & Demerouti, E. (2017). Job demands–resources theory: Taking stock and looking forward. *Journal of Occupational Health Psychology, 22*(3), 273–285.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 2 set readings. Bakker and Demerouti (2017) is the core reading for this lecture.

Sources for this lecture (1 of 2)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Bakker, A. B., & Demerouti, E. (2017). Job demands–resources theory: Taking stock and looking forward. *Journal of Occupational Health Psychology, 22*(3), 273–285. https://doi.org/10.1037/ocp0000056

Crawford, E. R., LePine, J. A., & Rich, B. L. (2010). Linking job demands and resources to employee engagement and burnout: A theoretical extension and meta analytic test. *Journal of Applied Psychology, 95*(5), 834–848. https://doi.org/10.1037/a0019364

Demerouti, E., Bakker, A. B., Nachreiner, F., & Schaufeli, W. B. (2001). The job demands resources model of burnout. *Journal of Applied Psychology, 86*(3), 499–512. https://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.86.3.499

Sources for this lecture (2 of 2)

Kahn, W. A. (1990). Psychological conditions of personal engagement and disengagement at work. *Academy of Management Journal, 33*(4), 692–724. https://doi.org/10.2307/256287

Schaufeli, W. B., & Bakker, A. B. (2004). Job demands, job resources, and their relationship with burnout and engagement: A multi sample study. *Journal of Organizational Behavior, 25*(3), 293–315. https://doi.org/10.1002/job.248

Schaufeli, W. B., Salanova, M., González-Romá, V., & Bakker, A. B. (2002). The measurement of engagement and burnout: A two sample confirmatory factor analytic approach. *Journal of Happiness Studies, 3*(1), 71–92. https://doi.org/10.1023/a:1015630930326